

We've been discussing the free will defense as a response to the argument from evil. This response assumes something about us: that we have free will.

But what does this mean?

To say that we have to free will is to say that some of our actions are up
to us; they are under our control.

Can we come up with a more informative **definition** of free will? What is it for an action to be up to us, or to be under our control?

Any definition we give will be (for reasons which will become clear) controversial. But notice that that does not mean that we can't know anything about which actions (if any) are free. To use an example we've discussed before, it is notoriously difficult to define words like "table" and "chair." But we surely know that some things are tables, and some things are chairs.

Further — and again, despite the fact that we cannot define “table” or “chair” — we know some things about what it would take to be a table or chair. I suggest that it is reasonable to suppose the same about free action.

The question we'll be asking ourselves for the next two weeks is: do we have free will? Our discussion will involve us considering the three strongest arguments **against** the view that we have free will.

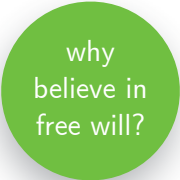
But before doing that it is worth asking why there is any reason to accept the common view that we do have free will. Are there any arguments in **favor** of the reality of free will?



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

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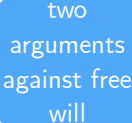
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We'll shortly consider some ways of

first let's think about how Edwards'

for fatalsn.

responding to Edwards' argument. But

argument might be related to an argument

actions. Could they give an argument

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

Suppose that someone did not believe in

there were truths about all our future

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

similar to Edwards' argument?

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

with reference to the being of truth about

God only shows up in premises (2) and

our future actions.

(5) Let's look at what happens if we



2*In the past, there were truths about

1. We have no direct facts.

all of our activities.

will perform various actions.

God knows that in the future I will

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

0 We have achieved what we

3 We have not the fact that

that if it is true that I will perform

then we have the choice about q.

some action, then I will prefer that

perform a certain action (1,2)

acaioid.



5* We have not noticed the fact

(3, 4, 5)

The fatalist argument

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

either.

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

things as fate, then there is no free will.

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

freedom that comes from fate.

responsing assumes something about what we have free will.

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that, at least sometimes, we have the ability to choose what we do.

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choses et what we will do?

spirit that some of our functions are up to us, and that we sometimes are able to























































































































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arguments against the view that we have free will.

freewill? Our discussion will involve us considering the strongest

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